

Tribe, '56 Toast Of Minors, Finds '57 Going Rough

By BILL SHORES

(United Press Sports Writer)

INDIANAPOLIS — (UP) —

The municipally-owned Indianapolis Indians, the toast of the minor leagues last year find the road in 1957 hard sledding.

Under first-year manager Andy Cohen, they climbed to fourth place before the bottom fell out. In a hurry — and at home too — they dropped to seventh after winning only 4 of 13 games at Victory Field.

Last year, they finished with a rush to cop the American Association pennant, league play-offs then took four straight from Rochester of the International League for an unprecedented post-season sweep.

Today, Cohen is searching for "something or somebody" to spark his slump-ridden champs.

"But," he said, "the boys aren't as bad as they've appeared lately."

Trying Too Hard?

Cohen described the Tribe's trouble as "a matter of everybody going bad at the same time. They certainly haven't stopped trying or hustling," the affable skipper added. "Maybe they've been trying too hard."

"We're liable to snap out of his slump just as suddenly as we went into it," Cohen said hopefully. "It's mainly a matter of the team settling down and regaining its confidence."

Strange as it may seem, the Indians have had more difficulty at home than on the road. They had won 15 of 28 games away from home before leaving town Sunday for stops at Omaha, Denver, Minneapolis and Wichita. Yet at home they're well below the 500 mark in winning only 12 of 30 games.

Colonels Start Skid

Last-place Louisville started the Indians on their downhill slide at the end of the Tribe's last road trip. The Colonels registered three victories during a four-game series, and although the Indians took three of their first five outings at home, the roof caved in during the next 8 games when the Tribe bowed 7 times. Six of those losses came at the hands of Omaha, Denver and Charleston, all trailing the Indians when they returned home.

During that woeful eight-game stretch, opposing teams scored 63 runs while the Indians tallied only 22.

Cohen hopes veteran pitcher Cloyd Boyer, recently acquired from Sacramento of the Pacific Coast League, might provide the spark needed.

Looking For Formula

"In fact, we won't hesitate to get anybody who will help the ball club," he commented. "We're trying to better the club in every way possible, but until we get something better we'll keep trying to fire up the team we have."

Cohen felt the current road trip might help snap the Tribe out of its doldrums.

"It may be better for the club that we're taking to the road for awhile. A change of scenery might be just what they need."

HOME NOT SWEET

NEW YORK (UP) — The New York Yankees aren't buying that business about home sweet home.

In 29 games at home so far this season, they've won 10 and lost 10. On the road, they've won 23 out of 35.

They open another home stand tonight against the Detroit Tigers.